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FORENSIC EXAMINATION REPORT (DIGITAL EVIDENCE)

STATE FORENSIC SCIENCE LABORATORY, FICTIONAL CAPITAL
Cyber & Digital Forensics Division

Report No.:	CFSL/CYB/2013/0447 (Specimen)
Reference Case:	SIT Case No. 09/2013 — State Recruitment Board Admission & Recruitment Matter (Specimen)
Exhibit:	One (1) SATA hard disk drive, 500 GB, seized from residence of accused mastermind V. Saxena (fictional)
Examiner:	Dr. N. Iyer, Senior Scientific Officer (fictional)
Method:	Bit-stream forensic imaging (write-blocked) followed by hash verification and file-metadata / slack-space analysis

1. Scope of Examination

The exhibit hard disk was received in a sealed condition on 14.06.2013 and was imaged using a write-blocking device prior to any analysis, in accordance with standard digital forensic procedure. The resulting forensic image was hashed (SHA-256) and all subsequent analysis was conducted on a working copy, preserving the original image unaltered.

2. Findings

2.1 A spreadsheet file named “CandList_Final.xlsx” (Specimen filename) was recovered from the active file system. Comparison of this file's internal revision metadata with an earlier cached auto-recovery version of the same file, recovered separately from unallocated disk space, revealed discrepancies in Column G (“Recommended By”) across 61 rows.

2.2 In the earlier (unallocated-space) version, Column G in these 61 rows contains specific designations consistent with public office — e.g. entries of the pattern “[Office-holder Designation] – Constituency/Department reference”. In the later, actively-saved version recovered from the live file system, the same 61 cells have been overwritten with the generic placeholder text “Minister” or “MLA”, without any corresponding change to the candidate roll numbers in the adjoining columns.

2.3 File metadata indicates the later version was last saved four days after the constitution of the Special Investigation Team, and two days before the exhibit was formally handed over to the investigating agency.

2.4 No corruption or hardware fault was found that would account for the discrepancy; the pattern of change is consistent with deliberate manual editing using standard spreadsheet software.

3. Opinion

In the opinion of this laboratory, the two versions of the file described above are not identical, and the later version reflects a deliberate substitution of specific identifying text with generic designations in the 61 rows identified at paragraph 2.2, carried out after the file's creation and prior to its production before the investigating agency.

[END OF EXCERPT — SPECIMEN DOCUMENT]

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CHARGE SHEET (EXCERPT)

IN THE COURT OF THE SPECIAL JUDGE (SIT MATTERS)
FICTIONAL CAPITAL

Case No.:	SIT/09/2013-CS (Specimen)
Under Sections:	466, 468, 471, 201 read with 120-B, Fictional Penal Code; Section 65/66 Fictional IT Act (tampering with computer source documents)
Accused No. 1:	V. Saxena, Examination Board Coordinator / alleged mastermind (fictional)
Accused No. 2:	K. Bhandari, computer data-entry operator engaged by the Board (fictional)

1. Summary of Allegations

It is alleged that between the constitution of the Special Investigation Team and the seizure of Accused No. 1's personal computer equipment, Accused No. 1 directed Accused No. 2 to open and edit the master candidate spreadsheet referred to in Forensic Report No. CFSL/CYB/2013/0447 (Specimen), and to replace 61 entries in the “Recommended By” column — which on forensic recovery are shown to have originally named specific holders of public office — with the generic terms “Minister” or “MLA”, before the hard disk was surrendered to investigators.

2. Evidence Relied Upon

(a) Forensic Examination Report No. CFSL/CYB/2013/0447 (Specimen) with annexed metadata comparison table.
(b) Statement of Accused No. 2 recorded under Section 164, Fictional Cr.P.C., describing instructions received from Accused No. 1.
(c) Call detail records showing contact between Accused No. 1 and Accused No. 2 on the dates corresponding to the file's last-modified timestamps.

3. Charges

Accused No. 1 and Accused No. 2 are charged with tampering with computer source documents and causing disappearance of evidence of the identities recorded in the original spreadsheet, with intent to screen certain unidentified public office-holders from investigation.